Interviewing At Amazon

Candidate Preparation Guide

What's included in this guide?

+ How To Use This Guide

+ Why Amazon?

+ Hiring Process Overview

+ Assessments Overview

+ Interview Process Overview

+ Post Interview

+ Resources

How To Use This Guide

Preparing for success

How to use this guide

Congratulations on making it to this exciting step in our interview process!

Not sure how to get started? We've included a lot of content for you in this guide, but ***we don't expect you to read it all or memorize it.*** You can reference this comprehensive guide as needed to understand our Amazon Stores culture, our peculiar hiring, and interview process as you prepare for your upcoming interview.

All of the content in this document is also available on **Amazon.jobs** and our **Candidate Support Site**.

Have additional questions? Feel free to reach out to your recruiter if you have any questions.

Why Amazon?

Learn about our culture

Why Amazon?

Amazon is guided by four principles: customer obsession rather than competitor focus, passion for invention, commitment to operational excellence, and long-term thinking.

Amazon strives to be Earth's most customer-centric company, Earth's best employer, and Earth's safest place to work. Customer reviews, 1-Click shopping, personalized recommendations, Prime, Fulfillment by Amazon, AWS, Kindle Direct Publishing, Kindle, Career Choice, Fire tablets, Fire TV, Amazon Echo, Alexa, Just Walk Out technology, Amazon Studios, and The Climate Pledge are some of the things pioneered by Amazon.

You'll also hear us say that at Amazon, it's always "Day 1." What do we mean? Our approach remains the same as it was on Amazon's very first day — to make smart, fast decisions, stay nimble, innovate and invent, and focus on delighting customers.

Discover more about who we are through our **Annual Letters to Shareholders from 1997 through today**.

Career advice and career journey highlights from Amazon's CEO Andy Jassy

About Amazon

What unites Amazon employees across teams and geographies is that we're all striving to delight our customers and make their lives easier. The scope and scale of our mission drives us to seek diverse perspectives, be resourceful, and navigate through ambiguity. Inventing and delivering things that were never thought possible isn't easy, but we embrace this challenge every day.

We seek top talent from all industries and a range of backgrounds to join our offices and operations centers around the world. People who succeed at Amazon have something in common—they are customer-centric, they are leaders and they are innovators.

We are excited to support you in your interview process with insights into who we are, recruiter interview tips, and a peek into life as an Amazonian.

Visit About Amazon to learn more about the latest Amazon news.

Our Employees

Hear from some of our employees about their experience working at Amazon

Meet Ruiz, SDE Amazon Ops

Meet Iqbal, Maintenance Tech III

Meet Phoung, Amazon Area Manager

Meet Michael, Principal Product Manager

Follow us

About Amazon Blog

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Amazon News X

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Who We Are

Our Positions

Public Policy

Awards & Recognition

Facts About Amazon

Our Impact

Our Planet

Our Workplace

- Our Employees
- Employee Benefits
- Diversity, Equity, & Inclusion
- Upskilling & Training
- Safety at Amazon
- Facilities
- Corporate Offices
- Amazon Tours

Our Culture

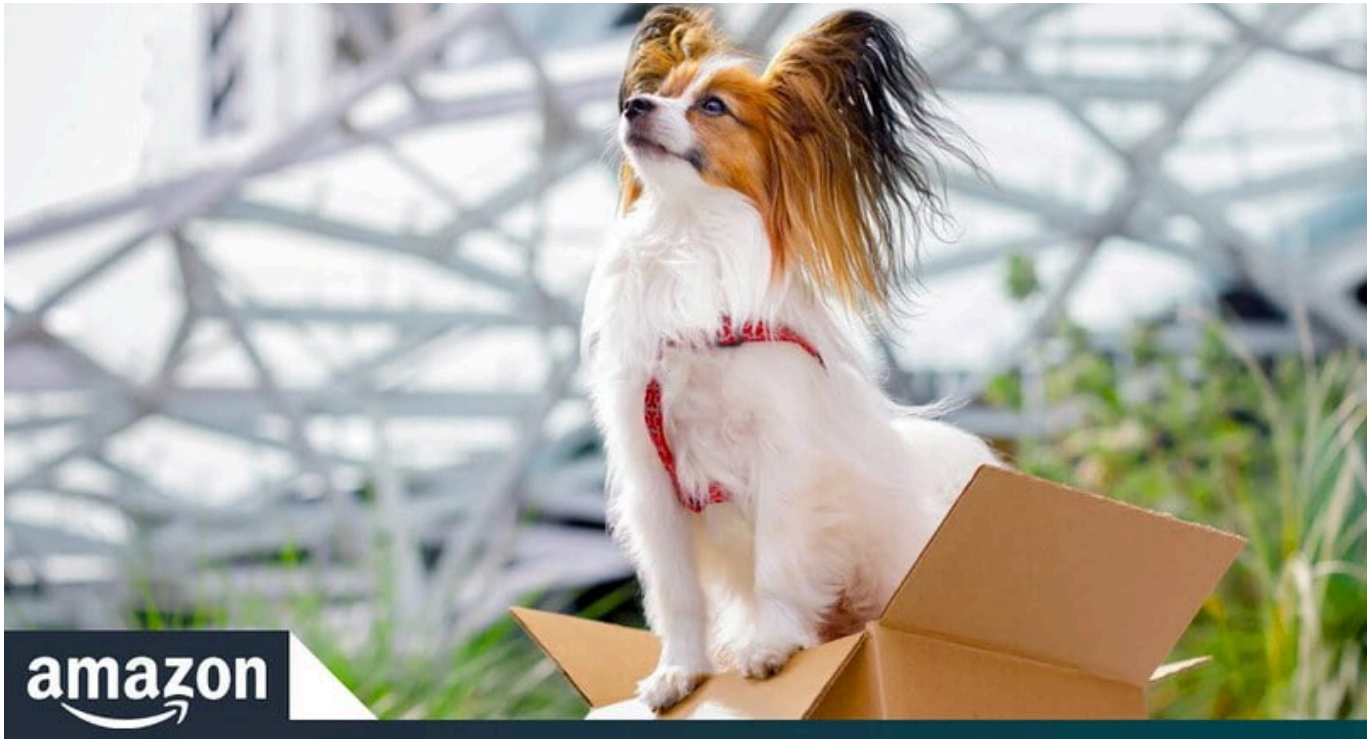
Learn about some of the highlights of Amazon's peculiar culture across our Field, Technology and Corporate roles.

Our Upskilling 2025 Programs

Amazon's Affinity Groups

How We Build Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion

How Amazon Approaches Accessibility

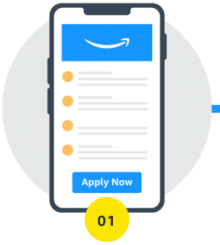


Learn more about Amazon's "Woof Pack"

Hiring Process Overview

Leadership Principles, STAR Method

Our Hiring Process

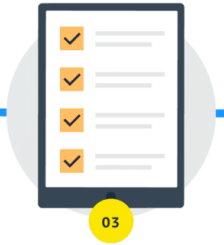


Job Search

Search our open roles on amazon.jobs. You can search by location, business category, job category, or keyword.

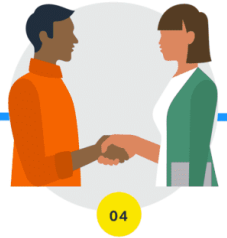
Apply

Click "Apply Now," then create an account or login in to an existing one. Follow the directions to complete your application.



Assessment (for certain roles)

Depending on the position, you may need to complete an assessment. The type and number of assessments will depend on the role you apply for.



Interviews

You will be notified via email if we're moving forward with your application. Most roles will require you to participate in one or two phone interviews, as well as a virtual or in-person panel interview with members of the Amazon team.

Next Steps

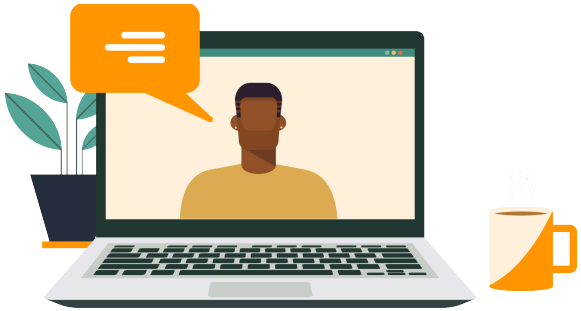
After your panel interview, expect to hear back from recruiting within 5 business days. You will also receive a Recruiting How's My Driving (RHMD) survey to give feedback on the process. You can check your status any time in our application portal.

Please note that this process may vary depending on your role.

Visit Interviewing at Amazon for more information.

Hiring Process Points of Contact

During the hiring process, you will have the opportunity to interact with several Amazonians. Although your recruiter will be your main point of contact during the process, here is a list of those contacts and how they assist in your interview journey. Please note that your individual experience may vary.



1 | Recruiting Team
A *sourcing recruiter* may have reached out to you directly via LinkedIn Inmail, email, or another platform to gauge your interest in the role. Your main point of contact is your *recruiter*, who has identified you as a potential candidate for the position. The *recruiting coordinator* is responsible for scheduling your phone interview, interview preparation call and interview.

2 | Hiring Manager
If selected, this will be your direct manager and in most cases, they will be able to answer specific questions about the role and the team.

3 | Recruiter Business Partners
In some businesses, recruiter business partners work alongside recruiters, sourcing recruiters, project managers, and hiring managers to place candidates into the most

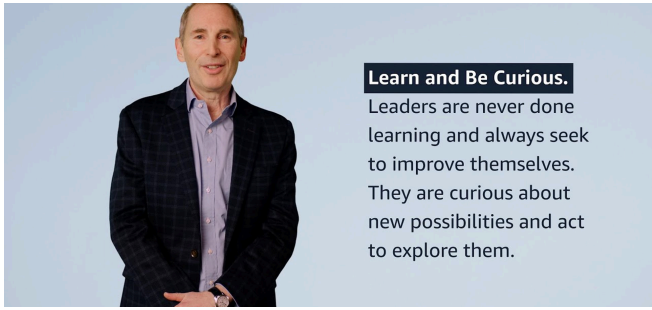
4 | Loop Interviewer
This may include an Amazonian from an indirect team or your direct team during your interview loop.

Our Leadership Principles

We use our **Leadership Principles** every day, whether we're discussing ideas for new projects or deciding on the best approach to solving a problem. It is just one of the things that makes Amazon peculiar.

All candidates are evaluated based on our Leadership Principles. The best way to prepare is to consider how you've applied the Leadership Principles in your previous professional experience.

Here are some **videos** of our Leadership principles to get you started.



Behavioral-based interviewing

Our interviews are rooted in behavioral-based questions which ask about past situations or challenges you've faced and how you handled them, using Leadership Principles to guide the discussion. We avoid brain teasers (e.g., "How many windows are in Manhattan?") as part of the interview process. We've researched this approach and have found that those types of questions are unreliable when it comes to predicting a candidate's success at Amazon.

Here are some examples of behavioral-based questions:

- Tell me about a time when you were faced with a problem that had a number of possible solutions. What was the problem and how did you determine the course of action? What was the outcome of that choice?
- When did you take a risk, make a mistake, or fail? How did you respond, and how did you grow from that experience?
- Describe a time you took the lead on a project.
- What did you do when you needed to motivate a group of individuals or promote collaboration on a particular project?
- How have you leveraged data to develop a strategy?

Keep in mind, Amazon is a data-driven company. When you answer questions, your focus should be on the question asked, ensure your answer is well-structured and provide examples using metrics or data if applicable. Reference recent situations whenever possible.

The STAR Method

The STAR method is a structured manner of responding to a behavioral-based interview question. Here's what it looks like:

S **SITUATION**

Describe the situation you were in, or the task you needed to do. Give enough detail for the interviewer to understand the complexities of the situation. This example can be from a previous job, school project, volunteer activity, or other relevant event.

T **TASK**

What goal were you working toward? Describe it.

Amazon veteran Cody Nelson shares practical advice for how to confidently ace your questions via the STAR method, including: concept overview, real-life examples, and tips to make yourself stand out on your interview.

A **Action**

Describe the actions you took. Use an appropriate amount of detail. What steps did you take? What was your contribution? Let us know what you did, not what your team or group did. Use the word 'I,' not 'we.'

R **RESULT**

Describe the outcome of your actions. Don't be shy about taking credit for what you did. What happened? How did it end? What did you accomplish? What did you learn? Provide examples using metrics or data if applicable.

Consider your successes and failures in relation to the Leadership Principles. Use examples that showcase your expertise and how you've taken risks, succeeded, failed, and grown. Keep in mind that some of our most successful programs have risen from the ashes of failed projects. Failure is a necessary part of innovation. We believe in failing early and persevering until we get it right.

Assessments Overview

Writing Samples, Technical Assessments

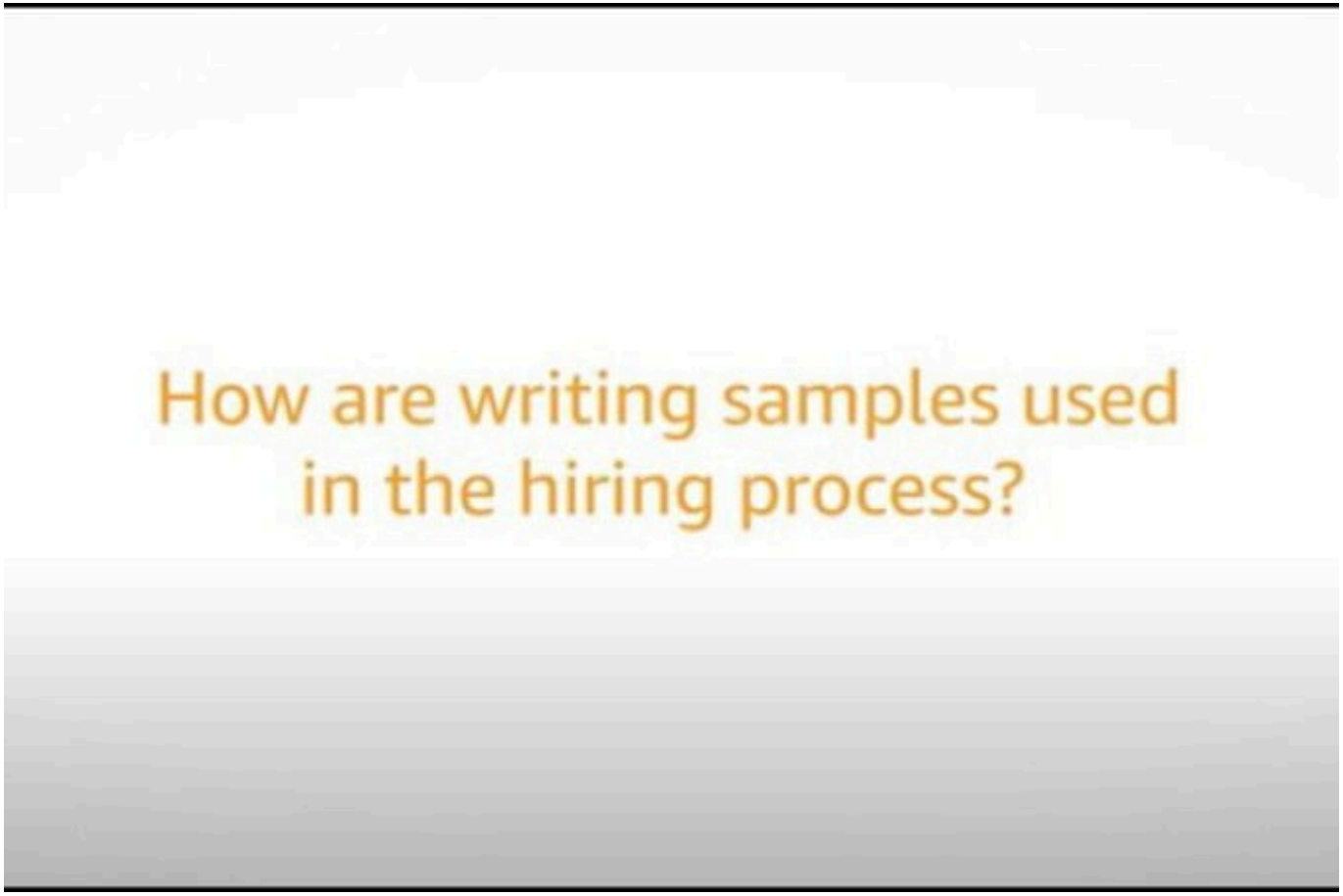
Writing Sample

You may be asked to complete a writing exercise as part of your interview process.

If required, your recruiting team will let you know and you may receive an email from **no-reply@mail.amazon.jobs** requesting that you complete a writing sample. Please note that these emails can occasionally be misdirected to spam/junk folders.

The intent of the writing exercise is to demonstrate your clarity of thoughts and expression, as well as your organization and structure.

Written and verbal communication skills are critical for success at Amazon. Some people communicate better in writing, while others verbally, this is why we like to give the opportunity to showcase both.



Technical Roles: Assessments

Click on the video to learn about the Amazon interview process from start to finish and what to expect.

For some roles you may be asked to complete an assessment. These assessments may include a technical assessment as per the following:

- **SDE I Assessment**
- **SDE II Assessment**
- **HackerRank Assessment**

Ask your recruiter if you have any questions regarding assessments.

If you are in a non technical role, please note that an assessment is usually not required during your interview process.

Interview Process Overview

Phone, Loop, Virtual and In-Person Interviews

Interview Process

Tips to succeed in an Amazon interview

Meet Florian, an Amazon Bar Raiser who has conducted over 250 Amazon interviews. In this video, he is sharing his top two interview tips to help you succeed in your interviews with us.

Our application and interview process differs from role to role, for some roles you may be asked to conduct one or more phone interviews, an in-person or virtual interview.

Some teams at Amazon incorporate role-specific exercises or online assessments into the interview process. You will be notified if the role you're interviewing for requires one of these.

Interview Tips

- **Be prepared** to explain what interests you about the role and the team(s) you'll be meeting with.
- **Be concise but detailed** in your answers; the right level of detail can be difficult to gauge. A good test is to pause after your answer to ask if you've given enough detail or if the interviewer would like you to go into more depth.
- **"Why Amazon?"** is a common question in our interviews. Help us understand what inspired you to explore an opportunity with us, so we can get a better sense of who you are.
- If you're asked a question but aren't given enough info to provide a solid answer, **ask for clarification.** If additional context isn't available, focus on how you'd attempt to solve the problem based the information given.
- Your interviewer will likely leave a few minutes at the end of the interview to answer questions. If we don't get to all of them, **don't hesitate to ask your recruiting point of contact.**

Learn more about interviewing at Amazon in this video.

Amazon Chime Messaging Platform

For phone interviews, video is not required and it may be scheduled to take place via our conferencing tool, **Amazon Chime.**

If you've been asked to do a remote/virtual interview, it will be scheduled to take place via our video conferencing tool, Amazon Chime.

If you're presenting, you'll need to download Chime to your desktop.

The meeting ID# will be emailed to you by your recruiting point of contact. For optimal sound quality, we suggedt that you use a headset with a microphone.

Please download and test the software prior to your interview.

Download Amazon Chime

Interview Checklist: Phone & Virtual

Phone Interviews

- **Connection:** If you're using a mobile phone, ensure you are in a place with proper coverage.
- **Duration:** Each phone interview usually lasts between 30 minutes to an hour.
- **Questions:** Come prepared with questions that you would like to explore in more detail about the interview process.

Phone & Virtual Interviews

- **Location:** During your interview, try be in a quiet and comfortable place with minimal distractions.
- **Resume or CV:** Interviewers will have a copy, but feel free to have one available for reference as well.
- **Chime:** Your upcoming phone or virtual interview will be scheduled to take place via our video conferencing tool, **Amazon Chime**.
- **Accommodations:** If you need an **accommodation** or have questions or concerns, please reach out, as we ensure reasonable accommodations for all individuals.

Virtual Interviews

- **Connection:** Ensure that your computer has a reliable connection and access to email.
- **Duration:** Each interview in your panel usually lasts between 45 minutes and an hour.
- **Questions:** Come prepared with questions that you would like to explore in more detail (e.g. initiatives/projects, team culture, scope of role). If you need clarity on anything, or have any additional follow-up questions, reach out to your recruiting point of contact.

For more tips, visit our Remote Interviewing page.

Interview Checklist: In Person

- **Check in:** Arrive 15 minutes early and check in for your interview. Have your government-issued photo ID ready (for example, your driver's license or passport).

- **Location:** You'll receive instructions via email. Some of our offices are dog-friendly. Let us know if you need an accommodation or have allergies.

- **Dress code:** Comfortable and casual. While some roles in our fulfillment centers may require certain clothing for safety reasons (such as closed-toed shoes), in most of our offices people wear everyday clothes. We're interested in what you have to say, not what you're wearing.

- **What to expect:** Interviews will be a mixture of questions and discussions about your experience. Be ready with detailed examples. Concise, structured answers are best.

- **Interviewers:** Depending on the role, you'll meet with two to seven people. They'll likely be managers, team members, stakeholders from related teams, and a Bar Raiser (usually a person from another team). All interviewers will assess your potential for growth beyond the position you're interviewing for. They'll evaluate how well your background and skills meet core competencies, along with how they relate to our Leadership Principles. We recommend approaching each interviewer the same way, rather than tailoring answers to their role. Interviewers will also often take notes on their laptops.

- **Resume or CV:** Interviewers will have a copy, but feel free to bring one as well.

- **Duration:** Each interview in your panel usually lasts between 45 minutes and an hour.

- **Lunch:** We'll provide lunch if your interview is scheduled during the lunch hour. Let your point of contact or your lunch buddy know if you have dietary preferences.

- **Technical roles:** If you're interviewing for a technical role, be prepared to white board.

Looking for more information? Visit our Candidate Support Center

Interview Loop

During the final steps in your interview process you will have the opportunity to meet several Amazonians to share more about your career and determine whether you are the right fit for the role you're applying to. Click the video below to learn more about preparing for your interview loop.

Job Interview Do's & Don'ts

Do's

- During your phone interview, try be in a **quiet** and comfortable place with minimal distractions.
- Ensure you have a **reliable internet connection** and access to email.
- **Remember your resume details.** In particular the experience most relevant to the role you're interviewing for.
- **Make a note of your questions.** Come prepared with a notepad and questions that you would like to explore in more detail (e.g. initiatives/projects, team culture, scope of role).
- **Let us know if you need an accommodation,** or have questions or concerns, as we ensure reasonable accommodations for all individuals.

For more tips, **visit our Candidate Support Site.**

Don'ts

- **Show up late to the interview.** If for some reason on the day it's unavoidable, call ahead to let your interviewer know your expected time of arrival.
- **Volunteer your weaknesses.** Whilst honesty is always the best policy, there is no need to volunteer your shortfalls unless asked directly.
- **Criticize your current or previous employer.** Doing so could give your interviewer the impression you're difficult to work with.
- Forget to ask your recruiter questions regarding **benefits and compensation** as your interviewer will not be equipped with those details.

Post Interview

When will you hear back from us?

Our 2 & 5 Promise

Our goal is to provide you an update within 2 business days after your phone interview(s) and within 5 business days after your panel interview. If you have been successful, your recruitment point of contact will inform you of the next steps.

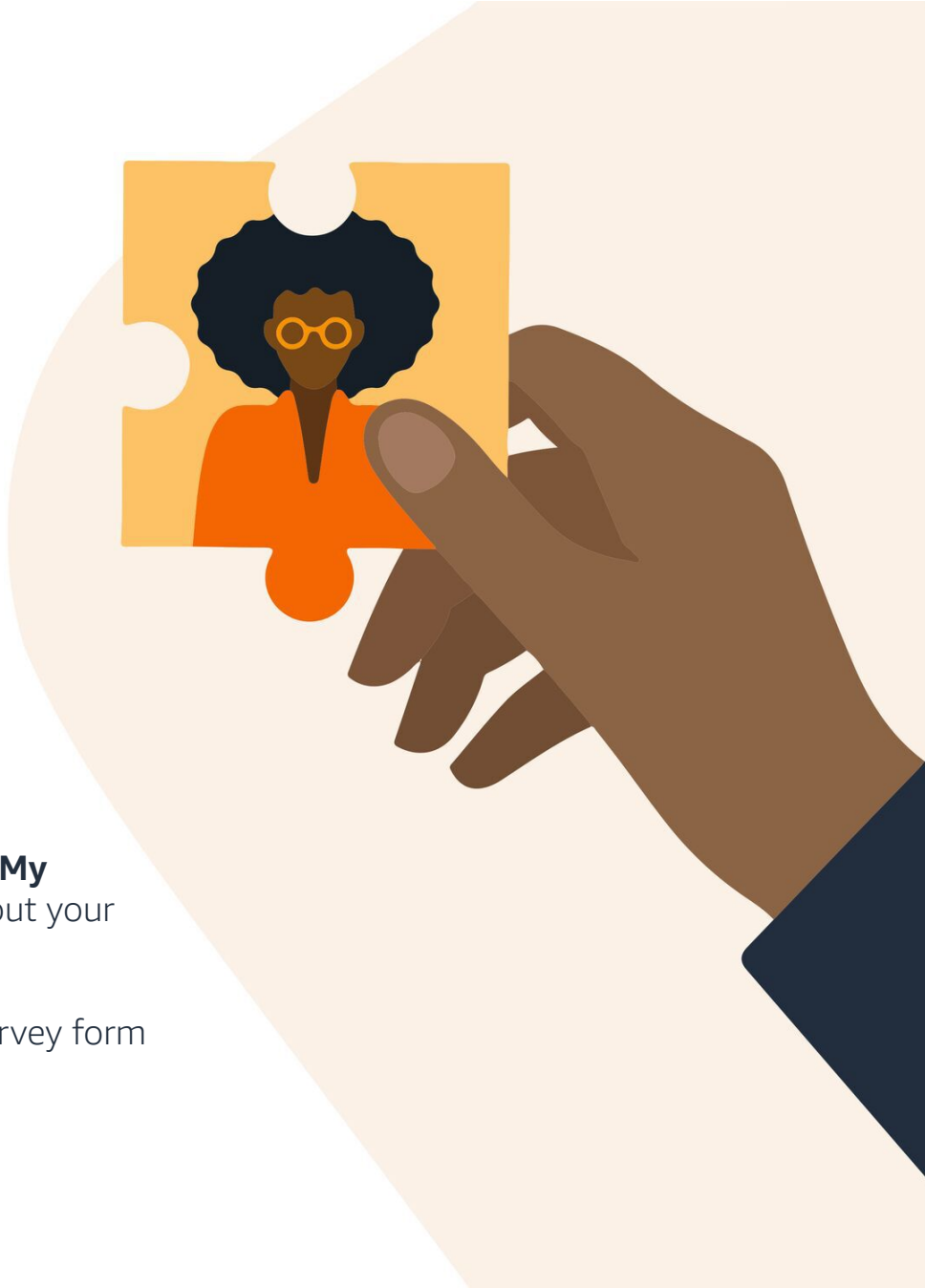
If you don't hear back, check your spam / junk mail folder, as communications from the recruitment team can sometimes be misdirected there.

You can check your status at any time in the application portal. Please note that we do not share detailed feedback post-interview.

Interactive poll not supported

View online version

Interview Process Comments



After your phone or onsite interview, you will be sent a **Recruiting How's My Driving (RHMD) survey** where you will have the opportunity to share about your experience during the recruiting process at Amazon.

We encourage you to take a moment after your interview to fill out the survey form to help us to continue to improve the candidate interview process.

Resources

Candidate Support Site,
Accommodations

Candidate Support Site

Our **Candidate Help Center** is dedicated to assisting Worldwide Amazon Stores (WWAS) candidates who are in the application and scheduling process. Our help center offers a comprehensive collection of frequently asked questions (FAQs) by candidates to help you in your interview journey with Amazon.

Application FAQs

Interview Process FAQs

Scheduling FAQs

STAR Method Preparation

Interview Preparation

More questions? Visit our Amazon Candidate Support site

Accommodations

As an equal opportunity employer, the Amazon group of companies is committed to a diverse workforce and is also committed to a barrier-free employment process.

In order to ensure reasonable accommodations for individuals protected by Section 503 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973, the Vietnam Era Veterans' Readjustment Assistance Act of 1974, and Title I of the Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990, as amended, individuals that require accommodation in the job application process for a posted position may contact us at 866-437-9078 for assistance.

For more information, please review the Accommodations page.

Thank you for reviewing our Amazon Interview Guide.

Best of Luck!

POWERED BY Turtl